

DEEPER LOOK ON

سُورَةُ الْاِنْسَانِ

TADABBUR NOTES

TAUGHT BY:

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بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

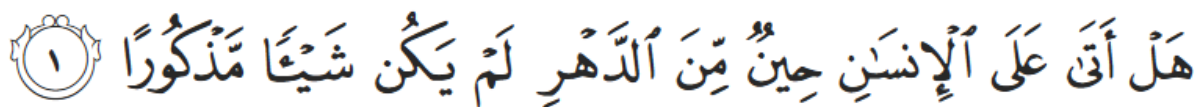
PRELIMINARY DISCUSSION 1: COMPARISON BETWEEN SURAH QIYAMAH AND SURAH INSAN



PRELIMINARY DISCUSSION 2: ORDER INSIDE SURAH INSAN



AYAT NO 1



Allah starts the surah by asking a question. In balagah, there are 2 types of questions:

1. تَصَوُّرٌ (A choice question. For e.g. Is it today or tomorrow?)
2. تَصْدِيقٌ (A yes OR no question)

A question can begin with either هل or ا (Ah). In classical Arabic, questions starting with ا (Ah), can either be تَصَوُّرٌ or تَصْدِيقٌ, but questions starting with هل can only be تَصْدِيقٌ.

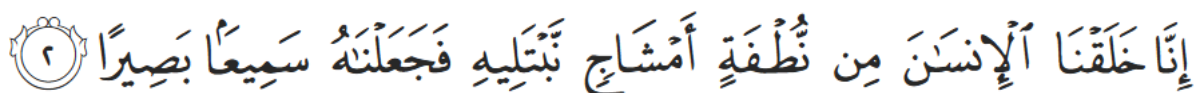
There can be multiple reasons to ask a question when the answer already known.

1. To put someone in their place. (Allah is asking have you forgotten or do you not know)
2. Setting someone straight. (Do you realize the way you're living your life shows you clearly don't remember where you came from)
3. To make a statement affirmative. (meaning yes there was a time when human beings were not remembered)

There are 2 words in Arabic for time. عصر and دهر. عصر means a time that passes fast. دهر means a time that slowly swallows up. Another reason why Allah used دهر here is that this word not only refers towards time, but also towards the vastness of space and the expanding universe, hinting towards the insignificance of the size of the human beings. This is an argument that even the atheist uses to justify that even if there was a god, the universe is so immense that he doesn't have time for us, but we use the same argument but conclude that even though the human beings are insignificant in size, what makes us considerable is our soul and the guilty conscious.

شئ refers to something that barely gets noticed. Allah is saying that were you even barely noticed.

AYAT NO 2



Human existence has two components: **the physical form and the spiritual form**. Ayah 2 is discussing the physical form and ayah 3 will discuss the spiritual form.

In the beginning, there are double emphasis, 1st through the word انا and 2nd through the word الانسان. Allah could have used a pronoun like "he" instead of using the word الانسان again as he already mentioned it in ayah 1. This concept is known as اظهار في مقام الإضمار in balagah. In balagah, if there is no emphasis, that means that the message is for normal audience, if there is a single emphasis it's for skeptical audience and if there are more than 1 emphasis, it's for rejecting audience. So for Muslims, our actions contradict our behavior so those emphases are important.

The primary meaning of نطفة is drop, but the secondary meanings are something **flawed** or **shame worthy**.

The word نطفة is singular, but the word امشاج is plural whereas normally for singular words there should be singular adjective. By using the plural form, Allah tells us that there are multiple mix happening at

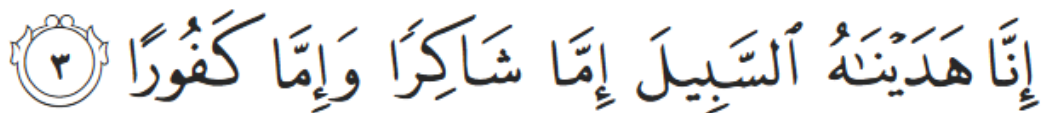
the same time in the **نطفة**, if he would have used a singular adjective, it would have meant only one mix. Some of the mixtures are:

- Drop being a mixture of the sperms.
- Each sperm being a mixture of unique genetic information.
- Father's health information being mixed in the drop.
- Mother's unique genetic information being mixed in the drop.

Primary meaning of **نبتلية** is **hardship**, but the secondary meaning is hardship that takes a **long period of time**. This word also connects with **الانسان** in such a way that the collective meaning becomes that **Allah created Human beings that have the abilities to take and pass the test**.

Allah didn't use the basic terms, **سَامِعٌ** and **مُبْصِرٌ**, but he used the **مبالغة** form of those words which is **سَمِيعًا** and **بَصِيرًا**, which means that Allah SWT gave human beings the best level of hearing and seeing. A human being also appreciates the ayats of revelation through **listening** and the ayats of creation through **seeing**.

AYAT NO 3



The actual guidance of Allah is that he has given us the **روح** from **علام الامر** which means that it will constantly try to connect back to Allah.

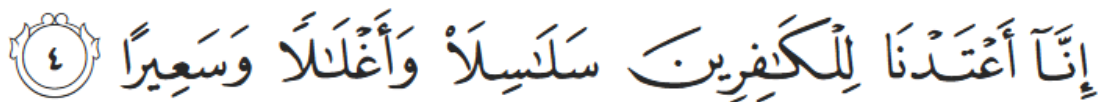
The preposition “to” in Arabic is either **إِلَى** or **لِ**. Allah has not used either of that before **السبيل**. In Arabic, if the prepositions are removed, it means that the word now includes all the meanings and even more. This is the most comprehensive way of saying something. So the meaning becomes we not only guided him, but guided him all the way through and guided him while staying along him, meaning placing the **روح** inside of us.

The actual sign of someone being grateful is that they use what they were given, so one is sincerely grateful only when they choose the right path to walk on.

Here Allah mentioned the people of jannah with their 1st quality, “**شاکر**” meaning Allah appreciates our gratitude.

The word **كفورا** is **مبالغة** or hyperbolized form which means two things, extremely ungrateful and extreme disbeliever. There can be multiple types of disbeliefs like believing in some aspects of Islam and rejecting others. Nowadays, the most extreme form of disbelief is atheism because it denies every aspect of Iman. Once someone has atheism, they don't owe anyone anything, and when someone doesn't owe anyone anything, they cannot become a person of gratitude. So basically extreme disbelief leads to extreme ungratefulness both of those qualities are combined in the word **كفورا**.

AYAT NO 4



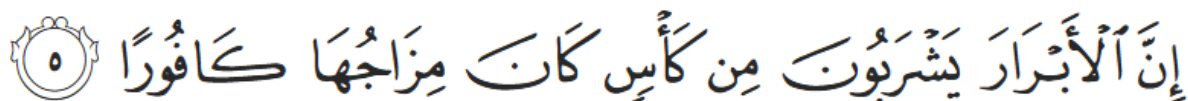
The word **إِنَّا** in the beginning suggests that no matter what the wrongdoers did in this life, Allah himself has prepared a punishment for them so no one should be disturbed by the fact that they got away in this life.

The second meaning of **سَعِير** is a fire that creates extreme thirst. In the contrary, the first thing Allah mentioned in ayah 5 is that the people of Jannah will be drinking.

SYMMETRY OF THE PASSAGE OF JANNAH



AYAT NO 5



Here Allah mentioned the people of jannah with their 2nd quality, “ابرار” meaning Allah sees the goodness in us.

The secondary meanings of **ابرار** includes being good, stable, growing, desirable, and transparent.

إِنَّ الْأَبْرَارَ يَشْرَبُونَ is **جملة اسمية** (nominal sentence) and one of the functions of a **جملة اسمية** is that it points at something else without speaking directly about it. It means here Allah SWT describes what the people of jannah will be doing at the same time hinting at the people of hell. So in other words, it will be the people of jannah that will be drinking, not the people of the fire.

In Arabic the same word is used for both present and future tenses. This word is called **مُضارع** so by definition one of its features is that it has a duality in its meaning, both present and future. Here Allah speaks about the future but at the same time it also indicates that it is as if the people of jannah are already drinking.

كأس is only used for wine glasses.

مِزَاج means mixed like modern day alcoholic cocktails.

كافور or camphor was an exotic element in old Arabian times.

AYAH 6

عَيْنًا يَشْرَبُ بِهَا عِبَادُ اللَّهِ يُفَجِّرُونَهَا تَفْجِيرًا ﴿٦﴾

Here Allah mentioned the people of jannah with their 3rd quality, “عِبَادُ اللَّهِ” meaning Allah sees our struggles to connect with him. Here Allah is attributing to the fact that the slaves of Allah are better than any other slaves of any other king. This also means that Allah is proud of those people.

كافور or camphor will be accessible at any time possible for the people of jannah.

AYAH 7

يُوفُونَ بِالنَّذْرِ وَيَخَافُونَ يَوْمًا كَانَ شَرُّهُ مُسْتَطِيرًا ﴿٧﴾

Here Allah mentioned the people of jannah with their 4th quality, “يُوفُونَ بِالنَّذْرِ” meaning they are the ones who fulfill their pledge, and the 5th quality, “يَخَافُونَ” meaning they are fearful.

The pledge here is referring to the very first pledge human beings took before being sending to the earth, اَلَسْتُ بِرَبِّكُمْ.

AYAH 8

وَيُطْعَمُونَ اَلطَّعَامَ عَلَىٰ حُبِّهِ، مُسْكِنًا وَيَتِيمًا وَاَسِيرًا ﴿٨﴾

الطعام here refers not only to food, but any kind of skill set someone teaches someone else. It's taking about empowering someone so that they get strong enough so that later they don't need help, but they are the one helping others.

AYAH 9

اِنَّمَا نَطْعِمُكُمْ لَوَجْهِ اللَّهِ لَا نُرِيدُ مِنْكُمْ جَزَاءً وَلَا شُكْرًا ﴿٩﴾

Here Allah mentioned the people of jannah with their 6th quality, “لَا نُرِيدُ مِنْكُمْ جَزَاءً” meaning they don't look for any reward from the people.

جزاء refers to doing good without expecting a favor and not feeling guilt even when responded with unpleasant behavior from the one with whom the person did good.

AYAH 10

إِنَّا نَخَافُ مِنْ رَبِّنَا يَوْمًا عَبُوسًا قَمْطَرِيرًا ﴿١٠﴾

One of the signs of the people of jannah is that they fear the stressful day that is coming, unlike other faiths.

AYAH 11

فَوْقَهُمْ اللَّهُ شَرَّ ذَٰلِكَ الْيَوْمِ وَلَقَّاهُمْ نَضْرَةً وَسُرُورًا ﴿١١﴾

نضرة refers to the outside beauty. سرورا refers to a type of happiness that is deep within and indescribable. By using those words, Allah has captured both external and internal beauty.

AYAH 12

وَجَزَّاهُمْ بِمَا صَبَرُوا جَنَّةً وَحَرِيرًا ﴿١٢﴾

جَزَّاهُمْ is an anchor from ayah.no.7. Allah says that they don't want any reward from the people so he will reward such people himself.

All the 6 qualities mentioned previously are not automatic. It requires a lot of صبر to achieve them.

صَبَّارٌ means a cactus. It was given this name because regardless of the harsh environment, a cactus still manages to survive and retain water inside of it. This name tells us that what quality Allah expects from someone who is patient.

AYAH 13

مُتَّكِئِينَ فِيهَا عَلَى الْأَرَائِكِ لَا يَرُونَ فِيهَا شَمْسًا وَلَا زَمْهَرِيرًا ﴿١٣﴾

People of jannah will be relaxing outdoor without worrying about either the heat or the freezing night.

AYAH 14

وَدَانِيَةً عَلَيْهِمْ ظِلَالُهَا وَذُلِّلَتْ قُطُوفُهَا تَذْلِيلًا ﴿١٤﴾

ذلول means when something is at your service in such a way that it moves at someone's command without them even saying something.

AYAH 15

وَيُطَافُ عَلَيْهِمْ بِثَانِيَةٍ مِّنْ فِضَّةٍ وَأَكْوَابٍ كَانَتْ قَوَارِيرًا ﴿١٥﴾

Servants would be circling the people of jannah.

AYAH 16

قَوَارِيرًا مِّنْ فِضَّةٍ قَدَرُوهَا نَقْدِيرًا ﴿١٦﴾

Silver will be unlike any other because it will be silver and transparent at the same time.

Drinks would be exactly measured according to the person's desire.

AYAH 17

وَيُسْقَوْنَ فِيهَا كَأْسًا كَانَ مِزَاجُهَا زَنْجَبِيلًا ﴿١٧﴾

Ginger was a very exotic good for the people back then.

AYAH 18

عَيْنًا فِيهَا تُسَمَّى سَلْسَبِيلًا ﴿١٨﴾

The word سلسبيل or سل سبيل might refer to, ask for path, meaning it could be some kind of transportation medium that takes us to any where we want.

AYAH 19

وَيَطُوفُ عَلَيْهِمْ وِلْدَانٌ مُّخَلَّدُونَ إِذَا رَأَيْتَهُمْ حَسِبْتَهُمْ لُؤْلُؤًا مَّنشُورًا ﴿١٩﴾

وِلْدَانٌ مُّخَلَّدُونَ might refer to babies 2 – 3 years old.

لُؤْلُؤًا doesn't only means one kind of pearl because every pearl from a different ocean is unique.

AYAH 20

وَإِذَا رَأَيْتَ ثُمَّ رَأَيْتَ نَعِيمًا وَمُلْكًا كَبِيرًا ﴿٢٠﴾

رَأَيْتَ means “you look”. Here Allah didn’t specifically mention someone like Rasool SAW or the people of jannah, he says “you”. This is an open invitation to everyone hearing those ayats to strive for jannah and make it their eternal home.

مُلْكًا كَبِيرًا might refer to Allah’s throne.

AYAH 21

عَلَيْهِمْ ثِيَابٌ سُنْدُسٍ خُضْرٌ وَإِسْتَبْرَقٌ وَحُلُّوا أَسَاوِرَ مِنْ فِضَّةٍ وَسَقَاهُمْ رَبُّهُمْ
شَرَابًا طَهُورًا ﴿٢١﴾

سندس is the finest dark colored silk.

اساور for men, would be manly bracelets.

The climax of the jannah experience will be that its dwellers would be served by Allah himself.

طَهُورًا is صَبِيغَةٌ مَبَالِغَةٌ which means that it does two things, it is itself pure and it also purifies.

This drink provided by Allah himself doesn’t have any flavors, unlike Camphor and Ginger, Allah just says that it will be a pure drink.

In ayah.no.6, the first time when the people of jannah were served drinks, their state at that time, as mentioned by Allah was عِبَادًا، meaning they were slaves. When they were served the second time, they were treated as kings as mentioned in ayah.no.20, مَلَكًا كَبِيرًا. Here when they are served for the third time, they are back to being slaves as indicated by word “رَبُّهُمْ” here. This means that the biggest blessing for someone is not to be a king, but to be the slave of Allah because that’s the ultimate freedom.

AYAH 22

إِنَّ هَذَا كَانَ لَكُمْ جَزَاءً وَكَانَ سَعْيُكُمْ مَشْكُورًا ﴿٢٢﴾

Allah highlight’s that this blessing is provided due to their سَعْيٍ, the “efforts” of human beings, not the results they generated.

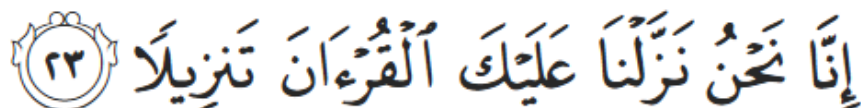
هَذَا here might suggest that no matter what rewards we were given before, but this is the ultimate reward, getting served and acknowledged by Allah himself.

The deeds of the people of jannah would be acknowledged by Allah as they didn’t ran after acknowledgement from people in this world as mentioned in ayah.no.9

People of jannah were شاکر, as instructed in ayah.no.3, so the reward of that is that in jannah, Allah himself thanks them for their efforts. Here Allah thanking us also means that he would be dedicating his words specifically to each one of us which is another incredible blessing.

All of this is in contrast to what Allah said in the beginning of this surah that we were not even something worthy of mentioning, but now Allah made us worthy of his mention because we acknowledged the honor and guidance he has given us.

AYAH 23



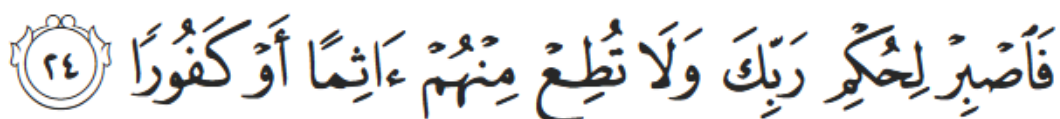
This ayah has 4 emphases, إِنَّا, نَحْنُ, نَزَّلْنَا, and تَنْزِيلًا, which shows the nature of the audiences its targeting.

Those emphases are important because Allah is telling that it is I who is doing everything, so if the disbelievers make fun of the prophet SAW, they are actually making fun of Allah himself.

As Allah himself took his time to deliver and teach the Quran, we as muslims should also be mindful of not just what we teach, but also how we teach it to others.

Quran gets its value from being a revelation of Allah SWT so now no matter who accepts it or not, whether it gets the endorsement from the people of influence or not, that won't increase or decrease its value.

AYAH 24



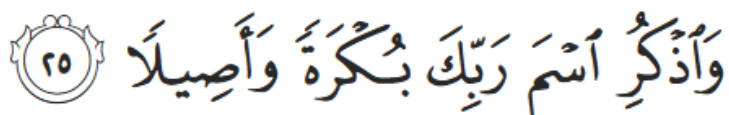
Rasool Allah SAW has been instructed to stay steadfast no matter how difficult it gets.

When the word صبر comes with a ل, like here اصبرل, it means humility and obedience over an instruction that's very difficult.

One of the meanings of تطع is becoming soft. Allah SWT here is saying to Rasool SAW not only to become soft with the message, but also at the same time stay soft with his manners.

According to some theories, آثماً is referring to utbah ibn rabiah and كفوراً is referring to Waleed ibn mugheera.

AYAH 25



Ayah.no.24 was about not getting influenced by the outside and ayah.no.25 is about influencing the inside.

ذكر means 2 things, to remember and to mention. Remembering is on the inside and mentioning is on the outside.

This ayah highlights Prophet Muhammad SAW's struggles throughout the day. Prophet Muhammad SAW is instructed to mention Allah SWT on the outside by giving dawah, and when he feels depressed by what people say to him, he is instructed to remember Allah on the inside as it will replenish his energy and bring him calm.

AYAH 26

وَمِنَ اللَّيْلِ فَاسْجُدْ لَهُ، وَسَبِّحْهُ لَيْلًا طَوِيلًا ﴿٢٦﴾

In order to cope with the struggles of the day, Allah SWT has given the remedy in this ayah.

سجود is mentioned in particular because head is where all the stress and anxiety is, so Allah SWT is telling our messenger SAW to surrender all your thoughts to Allah SWT and he will take care of everything.

Rasool Allah SAW is being instructed to declare Allah's perfection, سبحة, because no matter how imperfect his situation becomes, Allah SWT is the source of perfection.

AYAH 27

إِنَّ هَؤُلَاءِ يُحِبُّونَ الْعَاجِلَةَ وَيَذَرُونَ وَرَاءَهُمْ يَوْمًا ثَقِيلًا ﴿٢٧﴾

What makes the disbelievers so weak is that they are impulsive, looking for instant gratification, and when someone becomes impulsive they start to neglect responsibilities and the biggest responsibility being the heavy day, the day of judgement. So the physical and the immediate has become the reality of the disbelievers and if they are having a hard time processing what Rasool Allah SAW has to offer, it's only because their view of reality is limited and they are addicted to the immediate and not think about the consequences.

This ayah is the diagnosis of a materialistic society.

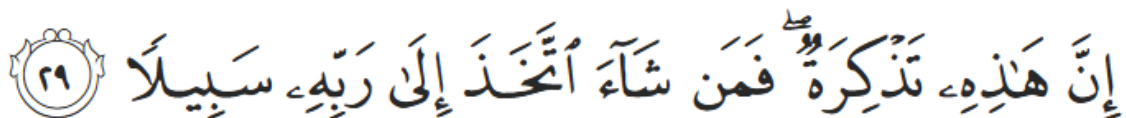
AYAH 28

نَحْنُ خَلَقْنَاهُمْ وَشَدَدْنَا أَسْرَهُمْ وَإِذَا شِئْنَا بَدَّلْنَا أَمْثَلَهُمْ تَبْدِيلًا ﴿٢٨﴾

نحن خلقناهم means that Allah SWT has created the people that are causing trouble for the Rasool Allah SAW meaning all the obstacles that Rasool Allah SAW's is facing, were created by Allah SWT for him.

وشددنا أسرهم means we tightened their knots, which is an expression describing that Allah SWT created human being and then put a limit on them like their families, society, circumstances, capabilities, impact they will create etc. So, human beings shouldn't think that they are free to do whatever injustice they can.

AYAH 29



This ayah and ayah.no:23 covers two sides of our relationship with the book of Allah SWT. On the one hand, we should keep in mind the status of Quran and Allah SWT but, on the other hand we are also supposed to have an intimate connection with them as well.

Ayah 23 taught us about the grandeur of the Quran, and this ayah teaches us about the intimacy and closeness with the Quran.

تَذْكِرَةٌ is مبالغة or hyperbolized form which means extremely powerful reminder.

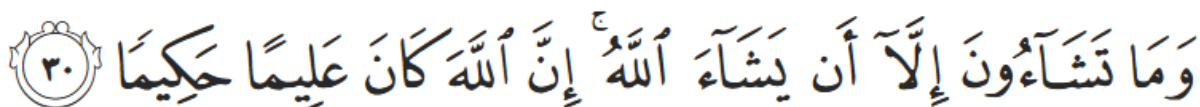
The Quran at its core is a reminder for the soul of its origin. When the soul was originated, it came into conversation with Allah SWT and the Quran is yet again Allah SWT having a conversation with us again.

The words, “فَمَنْ شَاءَ اتَّخَذَ إِلَىٰ رَبِّهِ سَبِيلًا” connects us back to ayah.no:3. Allah SWT guided us to the path in the beginning so now it's our responsibility to take that path.

This ayah is also a hope for someone who thinks it's too late now to turn back to Allah SWT.

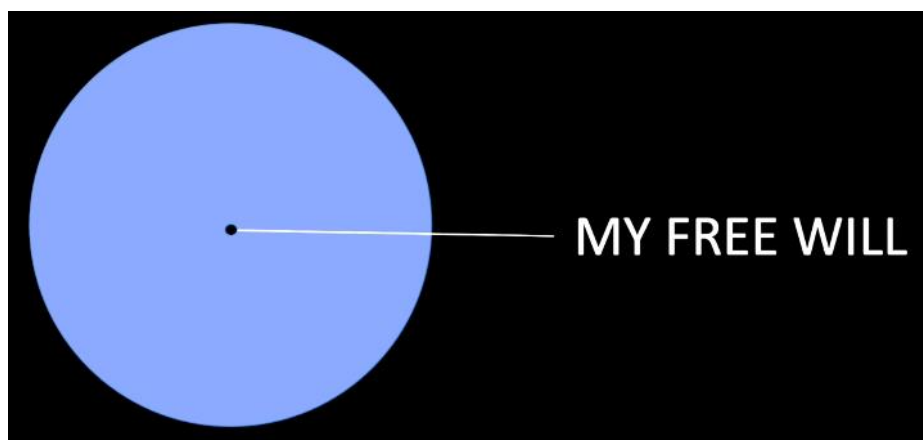
Taking the path back to Allah SWT includes two things, external change (worships, etc.) and internal change (intellectual and emotional progress). For most of the times, the Quran's consideration is the Internal change because it's way harder.

AYAH 30



The Islamic point of view of free will is that for the most part Allah SWT has complete will but in some cases, he has given human beings some choice.

The comparison of Allah's will and human being's will can be understood by the below diagram.



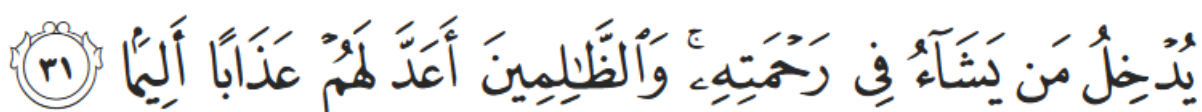
The blue circle shows Allah's will and the small black circle within shows human being's will. Our free will is encircled by Allah's will. We have a limited free will within Allah's will.

Some people have more free will as compared to others and Allah knows whom to give how much room. That's why he mentioned his name **عليما** at the end.

Allah knows what he is doing and everything is part of a much bigger plan. That's why he mentioned his name **حكيما** at the end.

The best example to address the confusion about predestination is as follow: people believe Allah to be **الهادي**, or the guide and says that, **"If Allah guides, I will be guided, if he doesn't guide me, I can't have guidance so it's all up to him, not up to me"**. Now what if we apply the same concept to all the other names of Allah like **الرزاق**, the provider, if someone says that **"If Allah feeds me, I would eat and if he doesn't I couldn't eat by myself because he is the provided, not me. I can't go get a job and make money and buy groceries because Allah is the provided"** we would realize that how stupid it was to claim that human beings don't have free will and hence are not responsible for their actions.

AYAH 31



Grammatically there are two translations of the first part, "He enters whoever wants, into his mercy" and "He enters whoever he wants, into his mercy".

There's a beautiful contrast in this ayah. He opened the door for jannah wide open by using **من يشاء**, but he limited the entry to hell **only and only** to those who really are **ظالمين**. **How do we know that "only" is mentioned twice?** By Allah putting **الظالمين** in the beginning and adding **لهم** before **عذابا أليما** because the standard sentence is, **"أَعَدَّ عَذَابًا أَلِيمًا لِلظَّالِمِينَ"**.

The question arises that why the people of hell described as **الظالمين**? **ظلم** actually means misplacing something. The main crime of the people of hell is that they misplaced their guilt, their soul, their gratitude in the wrong place and became **كفور**.

This ayah has a connection with ayah.no: 22. There Allah SWT said that their efforts are appreciated but after studying this ayah we come to the conclusion that yes their efforts will be appreciated but it's actually the rehman of Allah that we will be able to make it to jannah because whatever opportunities we got in this life to do good, were actually provided to us by him.